

way. Two of the options that are better than Chrome, and are alternatives to the banned UC browser, are Opera and Firefox. The considerations for a good mobile experience are features oriented towards touchscreens, cloud based acceleration to reduce mobile data usage, a comfortable enough night mode, and the ability to surf with a single hand. Unfortunately, there is not one single browser that meets all of these requirements, with each one having their own strong points. Choosing a mobile browser depends on your usage pattern on the desktop as well, and if you want to continue browsing across platforms. Check out the best mobile browsers and their strong points.

Opera

Opera has a number of browser options on both platforms, and is not just one single app. The development is continuous and the browser keeps adding an increasing number of convenient features. If you want the best user experience, then this is the browser to go for. On Android, you have Opera, Opera Mini, Opera Beta and Opera Mini Beta. The beta versions obviously are buggier, but still very good and the bugs are only with the latest features. These versions are obviously for pro users. For those just looking for a good all round browser, Opera is the way to go.

There are a few features that really improve the user experience. The first is an AI-driven custom news feed, that you need to set up, but then gives you direct links from all your favorite sources in an easy to scroll list. Each of the features have tweaks that let you customise the experience further. For example, you can adjust the settings in the night mode according to what you find the most pleasing. The download manager is powerful, and allows you to share files from the browser itself. If you use Opera on a computer, then you can sync the bookmarks across both versions, so changes in one will be reflected in the other.

Opera Mini is the browser that is ideal for spotty 2G connections, or for those with long commutes. You can download pages and read them later. There is also an offline file transfer feature in Opera Mini. Then there is an integrated video player as well. These are the features that will be appealing to many local users.

For iOS users, Opera has a very special browser that offers a refined touchscreen experience. There is no Opera Mini available here. Opera Touch is just very minimal and leaves most of the screen estate for the web page, with the buttons being discreet. The entire user interface has been designed for a one hand experience, so it is really easy to use on the side while working on a computer, during a commute, or while relaxing on the sofa. There are gesture options for moving between tabs and accessing media controls. The best thing is the search, which allows you to use your voice or scan a QR code, and is really fast. You can sync bookmarks, notes and links with a web version, adding everything to what is known as the Flow. This is a helpful feature when you want to continue surfing on the go where you left off on your laptop.

All Opera browsers have ad blocking, free VPN and cloud-based acceleration for loading web pages. The last part means that mobile data consumption is considerably reduced. These features put together mean that Opera is just about the best browser available on smartphones, and the different versions only compete with each other.

Firefox

Firefox is fierce about protecting your privacy, so all the versions that they have block third party cookies, online trackers and ad delivery networks. All of this means that your browsing speed increases and your data consumption is reduced. The only thing getting on to your phone is the actual content that you want to access. It is like having private mode switched on by default. Another good thing about Firefox is that it works very well with the desktop version, allowing you to sync passwords, open tabs and bookmarks. It is very easy to move to the PC version from the phone and vice versa.

One of the good design aspects about this browser is that the tabs are very easy to navigate and switch between. They are displayed as a stack of cards, and inform you at a glance what website it is. Another really helpful feature is the ability to surf the web using a smart TV that supports streaming. This really changes the experience of surfing the web, especially if you have a

large TV. You can move your surfing to the living room, and for video streaming sites or social media, or even interactive infographics, this is just an awesome feature that can entirely transform your web surfing experience.

Just like Opera, Firefox too has a number of versions available. There are Firefox and Firefox Lite, then there are the beta version, Firefox Beta. Additionally, you can also get the very latest features, as well as the buggy versions which are in the nightly builds, so that one is Firefox Nightly, which used to be known as Firefox Aurora. Then there is Firefox Focus, which has a more advanced version of private mode from the get go. It prevents a wide range of online trackers, so your browsing habits will not be recorded, and there won't be data machines building psychographic profiles based on your digital footprints to deliver targeted ads to you. Then, there is also a built in ad blocker. The Lite mode additionally allows you to browse using the text only, and nukes all images, making the surfing experience even faster, especially on spotty connections. Erasing your passwords and browsing history is also very easy, but for the sake of convenience you can choose to keep them. If you are worried about privacy or are very paranoid, then this is the browser to use.

Chrome

Google Chrome is a fast browser for mobile platforms, and one of the best aspects about it is the tab viewing feature. It fits in more tabs in the available screen real estate than other browsers, taking advantage of newer smartphones with higher pixel densities. Syncing with the PC version is very easy, and allows you to use the same tabs, bookmarks and passwords. You can leave off on one platform and continue surfing on another. It only requires users to login with their Google accounts on all platforms. Google claims it uses AI to improve your news feeds, but this is clearly a sneaky way of delivering you more ads and getting more publishers on board their ad delivery network. This is a useless feature anyway.

Chrome allows you to download content from web pages, and this includes videos as well. Google uses its in-house tech to compress the content before delivering them to you, which